

Witness Statement — Recorded under Section 161 CrPC

Witness: Anand Prakash, Age 29, Accountant, Iyer Textiles Pvt Ltd

Recorded on: 18 March 2024 | Investigating Officer: Sub-Inspector R. Vignesh

Statement

I have been employed as accountant with Iyer Textiles Pvt Ltd since June 2021. I handle the day-to-day bookkeeping and bank reconciliation for the firm, including the joint account opened with Mr. Suresh Babu Menon at Indian Overseas Bank, T. Nagar Branch.

I state that the joint account was opened on 3 January 2024 with an initial deposit of Rs. 50,000 made by the complainant, Mr. Rajesh Kumar Iyer. I confirm that as per the account statements I reviewed, Mr. Suresh Babu Menon did not deposit the agreed sum of Rs. 12,50,000 at any point between January and March 2024.

I further state that on 22 January 2024, a withdrawal of Rs. 3,40,000 was made from the joint account. To the best of my knowledge, this withdrawal was authorised by both signatories, since the account required joint signatures for any withdrawal above Rs. 1,00,000. I did not personally witness who initiated the withdrawal request at the bank counter.

I recall that Mr. Iyer informed me around 25 January 2024, not in March as he may have stated elsewhere, that he suspected something was wrong with the account, and asked me to prepare a detailed reconciliation, which I completed by 2 February 2024.

I am aware of at least two reminder emails sent to Mr. Menon, dated 20 January and 5 February 2024. I am not aware of any reminder sent on 28 February 2024 as I did not draft or send one on that date.